

GARIL AI — User Manual & Walkthrough

Governed AI for Research, Instruction and Learning

A practical guide for students, lecturers, researchers, and university administrators.

What is GARIL AI?

GARIL AI helps you move from a research topic to a structured, citation-backed academic document — and helps lecturers supervise students and institutions govern AI use.

You can:

- Generate and evaluate research ideas
- Build literature-backed outlines
- Draft papers, assignments, theses, and dissertations with verified citations
- Keep notes, datasets, and figures in a Research Notebook
- Supervise student projects, chapters, and assignments (lecturers)
- Monitor AI usage, tokens, audit logs, and policies (admins)

GARIL is designed for universities, colleges, and polytechnics. Your account is tied to your institution.

Who this guide is for

You are...	Start here
Student	Register & login → Student walkthrough
Lecturer / researcher	Register & login → Lecturer walkthrough
University admin	Admin login
Platform / super admin	Super-admin walkthrough

Before you begin

1. Your **university must be onboarded** on GARIL (ask your ICT / research office if you cannot find it at signup).
2. **Lecturers** must use an **institutional email** (personal free-email domains are blocked).
3. **Students** and **lecturers** have separate signup and login pages — use the correct one.
4. AI writing uses a **token allowance**. If generation stops with a quota message, contact your university admin.

Getting started (everyone)

1. Create your account

Lecturers and researchers

1. Open the GARIL website.
2. Go to **Register** (/register).
3. Select your **university** from the list.
4. Enter your institutional email, name, and password.
5. Submit, then go to **Login** (/login).

Students

1. Open the GARIL website.

- 2. Go to **Student Register** (/student/register).
- 3. Select your university and complete the form.
- 4. Log in at **Student Login** (/student/login).

After login — where you land

Role	Home screen
Lecturer / researcher	Dashboard (/dashboard)
Student	Student Dashboard (/student/dashboard)
University admin	Governance Dashboard (/admin)
Super admin	Platform overview (/super-admin)

2. Choose the right research type

When you start Research Assistant, pick the document type that matches your goal. This controls structure, length, and how many scholarly sources the AI aims to use.

Research type	Best for	Rough length	Min. distinct sources (target)
Assignment	Coursework essays	~2,000 words	20
Conference paper	Symposium / conference	~3,000–4,000	20
Journal / Research Paper	Peer-reviewed article style	~4,000–6,000	25
Undergraduate project	Final-year project	~6,000–8,000	25
Thesis	Master's thesis	~8,000–10,000	40
Dissertation	Doctoral dissertation	~10,000–12,000	50

Tip: Pick the type first. Changing type later changes headings and citation expectations.

Part A — Lecturer / researcher walkthrough

A1. Know your dashboard

After login you see quick tools:

Tool	What it does
Research Assistant	Ideas → outline → full draft with citations
Research Notebook	Notes, datasets, questionnaires, figures
Projects	Supervise student theses / dissertations / folders
Reviews	Review submitted chapters and drafts
Assignments	Publish briefs and mark submissions
Students	See your supervisees
Analytics	Snapshot of supervision activity

A2. Walkthrough: write a research paper (core path)

This is the main day-to-day flow.

Step 1 — Open Research Assistant

1. From the dashboard, click **Research Assistant**.
2. You arrive at `/research`.

Step 2 — Set up your topic

1. Choose your **discipline** (field of study).
2. Enter a clear **topic** (be specific; vague topics produce vague ideas).
3. Select the **research type** (Assignment, Journal, Thesis, etc.).
4. Optionally refine focus (empirical, theoretical, applied, ...).
5. Click to **generate research ideas**.

You will see several idea options. Read titles, aims, and suggested questions. **Select one idea** to continue.

Step 3 — Build an outline

1. Continue to **Outline** (`/research/outline`).
2. GARIL searches academic sources and drafts a structured outline grounded in real papers.
3. Review the outline and the "sources for further reading".
4. Edit if needed, then proceed.

Step 4 — Configure the draft

1. Open **Generate** (`/research/generate`).
2. Choose **citation style** (for example APA) and any paper options offered on screen.
3. Confirm you are ready to generate the full document.

Step 5 — Generate the paper

1. Open **Paper** (`/research/paper`).
2. Generation streams live (you see text appear section by section).
3. Wait until the run finishes. Do not close the tab mid-stream if you can avoid it.
4. Review headings, claims, and the **References** list.

What "citation-backed" means: GARIL retrieves real papers first, then asks the AI to write using that source bank — so references should map to retrieved literature, not invented titles.

Step 6 — Save and return later

1. Open **Saved** (`/research/saved`) to find completed papers.
2. Re-open any item to continue reviewing or exporting from the UI tools available on that screen.

Assignment shortcut: use `/research/assignment` when your deliverable is coursework-shaped rather than a journal article.

A3. Walkthrough: Research Notebook

Use the notebook when you need a living workspace, not only a one-shot paper.

1. Open **Research Notebook** (`/research/notebook`).
 2. Create or select a **project**.
 3. Add **documents**, **references**, **datasets**, or **questionnaires** as your study progresses.
 4. Use visualizations / figures where the UI offers them.
 5. Return anytime — your project stays under that notebook entry.
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A4. Walkthrough: supervise a student project

1. Open **Projects** (/supervision/projects).
 2. Open a student's project (or create one according to your institution's process).
 3. Review **pages / chapters** in the editor.
 4. For chapters awaiting you:
 - o Approve or reject
 - o Leave review notes
 - o Use **AI chapter review** as a second opinion (you remain the academic decision-maker)
 5. Approve **topics** when students submit them for approval.
 6. Attach **assignment briefs**, set scores, and export documents when needed.
 7. Check **Reviews** (/reviews) for items waiting in your inbox.
 8. Use **Students** (/students) to track who you supervise.
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A5. Walkthrough: publish an assignment brief

1. Open **Assignments** (/assignments).
 2. Click **New** (/assignments/new).
 3. Write the brief (instructions, deadlines, expectations).
 4. Save / publish so students can see it under their Assignments area.
 5. Later, open the assignment to review submissions and export scores.
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A6. Notifications and analytics

- **Notifications** (/notifications) — chapter submissions, feedback events, and workspace updates.
 - **Analytics** (/analytics) — high-level view of supervision activity in your workspace.
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Part B — Student walkthrough

B1. Know your student home

Area	Path	Use it to...
Dashboard	/student/dashboard	Start your day
Research Assistant	/student/research	Ideas → outline → paper
Research Notebook	/student/research/notebook	Notes and project materials
Student Assistant	/student/assistant	Hub for projects, assignments, feedback
Projects	/student/projects	Write thesis / dissertation chapters with your supervisor
Assignments	/student/assignments	Open lecturer briefs and submit work
Feedback	/student/feedback	Read supervisor comments
Notifications	/student/notifications	Stay on top of updates

B2. Walkthrough: produce coursework or a paper

Same stages as lecturers, under student URLs:

1. **Research Assistant** → choose discipline, topic, research type.
2. **Generate ideas** → pick one.

3. **Outline** → review literature-backed structure.
4. **Generate / Paper** → stream the draft.
5. **Saved** → reopen finished work.

Paths look like:

```
/student/research → /student/research/outline → /student/research/generate →
/student/research/paper → /student/research/saved
```

Watch your tokens. Each generation uses part of your allowance. If you hit the limit, ask your lecturer or university admin to increase your quota.

B3. Walkthrough: supervised thesis / dissertation project

1. Open **Student Assistant** → **Projects**, or go to `/student/projects`.
2. Open your project (or create one if allowed).
3. Write in the chapter / page editor.
4. **Submit** chapters or topics when ready for supervisor review.
5. Check **Feedback** for comments and required revisions.
6. Respond to notifications so you do not miss approval or deadline messages.

B4. Walkthrough: complete an assignment from your lecturer

1. Open **Assignments** (`/student/assignments`).
2. Select the brief.
3. Follow instructions and deadlines.
4. Submit through the screens provided for that assignment.
5. Check **Feedback** after marking.

Part C — University admin walkthrough

Login at `/admin/login`. You only see modules your role is allowed to use.

C1. Daily governance check

1. Open **Governance Dashboard** (`/admin`).
2. Scan **alerts**, adoption, and platform health.
3. Open anything urgent (alerts or incidents).

C2. Manage usage and cost

1. **Usage Analytics** (`/admin/analytics`) — who uses GARIL by faculty / department / programme.
2. **Token Usage** (`/admin/tokens`) — consumption by group or user; raise or reset allowances when students are blocked.

C3. Accountability

Page	Use when you need to...
Audit Log (<code>/admin/audit</code>)	Investigate who did what
Alerts (<code>/admin/alerts</code>)	Respond to high-risk or policy signals
Incidents (<code>/admin/incidents</code>)	Record investigation and resolution
Users (<code>/admin/users</code>)	Activate, suspend, or deactivate accounts

C4. Reporting and integrity

- 1. **Reports** (/admin/reports) — generate summaries for Management, Senate, or auditors.
- 2. **AI Contribution Statements** (/admin/contributions) — verify that AI-assistance records exist (without opening private research text unnecessarily).
- 3. **Research Provenance** (/admin/provenance) — process history for integrity reviews.

C5. Controls

- 1. **Policies** (/admin/policies) — institutional AI rules that can trigger alerts.
- 2. **Privacy** (/admin/privacy) — who may access research-related data.
- 3. **Retention** (/admin/retention) — how long records are kept or deleted.

Note: Some older menu items (risks, compliance, inventory, approvals) may redirect to the main admin hub if those screens were retired.

Part D — Super-admin walkthrough

Login at /super-admin/login .

Task	Where
See all onboarded universities	/super-admin
Onboard or manage a university	/super-admin/universities
Platform users	/super-admin/users
University / platform admins	/super-admin/admins
Token defaults / platform usage	/super-admin/tokens
Activities	/super-admin/activities
Research content oversight	/super-admin/research

Typical first-week setup:

- 1. Onboard the university.
- 2. Create or invite a university admin.
- 3. Set student and lecturer token defaults.
- 4. Confirm lecturers and students can register against that university.

Part E — Tips for better results

Write better prompts / topics

- Prefer: "Effect of blended learning on undergraduate engagement in Nigerian public universities"
- Avoid: "Education and technology"

Always review AI output

GARIL grounds writing in retrieved literature, but **you** remain responsible for:

- Accuracy of claims
- Correct interpretation of sources
- Compliance with your department’s integrity policy

- Declaring AI assistance where required

If generation fails or looks wrong

1. Check you are still logged in.
2. Check **token remaining** (especially students).
3. Retry with a clearer topic or different research type.
4. Contact your university admin if login or university list is wrong.
5. Contact platform support if the whole site or AI service is down.

Privacy

- Governance staff generally oversee **usage and integrity**, not your private drafts — unless institutional policy explicitly allows access.
- Do not paste confidential personal data (patient records, exam scripts with student IDs, etc.) into prompts unless your university policy permits it.

Quick reference — important links

Action	Lecturer	Student
Login	/login	/student/login
Register	/register	/student/register
Home	/dashboard	/student/dashboard
Research	/research	/student/research
Notebook	/research/notebook	/student/research/notebook
Projects	/supervision/projects	/student/projects
Assignments	/assignments	/student/assignments
Saved papers	/research/saved	/student/research/saved

Admin	Path
University admin login	/admin/login
Governance hub	/admin
Super-admin login	/super-admin/login
Super-admin home	/super-admin

Glossary (plain language)

Term	Meaning
Research type / scope	The kind of document you are writing (assignment, thesis, ...)
Outline	Structured plan of sections before the full draft
Citation bank	The real papers GARIL fetched for this run
Tokens	Units of AI usage; your account has a limit

Supervision project	Shared folder/chapters between student and lecturer
Brief	Assignment instructions published by a lecturer
Provenance	Record of how AI assisted a piece of work

One-page cheat sheet

Lecturer — first paper today

1. Login → Dashboard
2. Research Assistant → topic + type → ideas
3. Outline → Generate → Paper
4. Review → Saved

Student — first assignment today

1. Student login → Dashboard
2. Research Assistant (same idea → outline → paper flow)
3. Or open Assignments from your lecturer
4. Check Feedback and Notifications

Admin — first week

1. Admin login → Governance Dashboard
2. Users + Tokens
3. Policies + Alerts
4. Generate a first Report for leadership

End of user manual. For technical setup, APIs, and deployment, see `docs/PROJECT_MANUAL.md` .